

LASER EYE SURGERY

Using a scalpel to reshape a patient's cornea (the outer transparent part of the eye) and correct their vision was pioneered by the Spanish ophthalmologist José Barraquer in the 1950s. Following years of research and practice, the first reshaping procedure using an ultraviolet laser as the cutting tool was performed in 1988 by the American doctor Marguerite McDonald.



WOW!

In 1665, the British doctor Richard Lower carried out the first ever blood transfusion procedure—between two dogs.

ROBOTIC SURGERY

Although a robot that can perform operations independently has yet to be invented, robots have been assisting with operations since the early 1980s. The first was the Arthrobot, developed in 1983 by a team of Canadian researchers led by Dr. James McEwen. The robot moved a patient's leg during surgery by following a surgeon's voice commands.

IN GOOD HEALTH

The robot can perform very precise, delicate procedures.

The surgeon uses a computer to control the robot.

Modern surgery featuring an assistant robot surgeon

